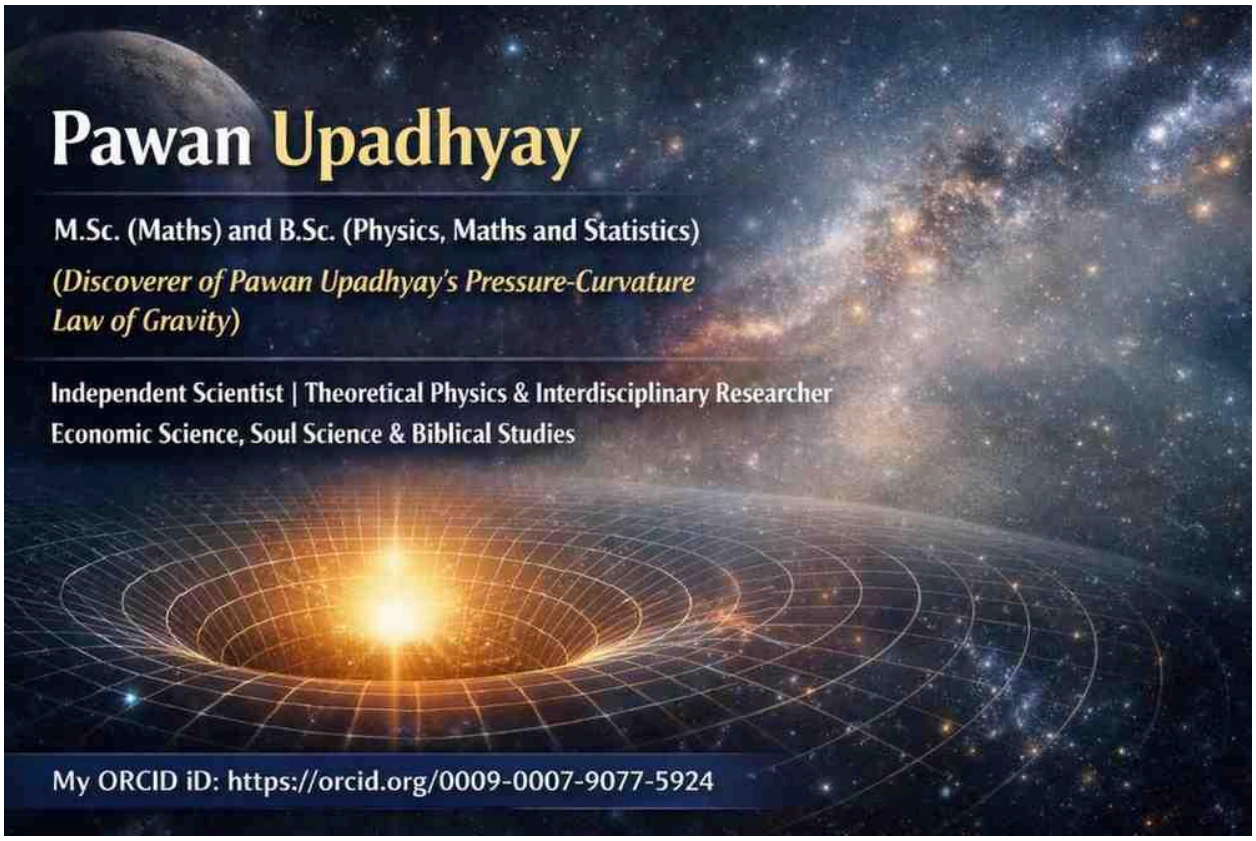
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SEEK AND FIND

A Research Paper on the Gospel of Thomas, Saying 2

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Abstract

Gospel of Thomas, Saying 2 presents a remarkable journey of the seeker. The saying begins with the command to continue seeking until finding occurs. The Coptic witness then describes a progression from **finding to trouble, from trouble to astonishment, and from astonishment to reigning over the All**. The surviving Greek witness presents a closely related but not identical progression: **seeking → finding → astonishment → reigning → resting**.

This research paper develops a Christian theological reading of this progression. The seeker is understood as a person who refuses to give up searching. Within the proposed theological framework, the seeker searches for **Knowledge, Wisdom, and Truth**. The discovery of Truth may disturb the seeker's previous understanding and produce an inner crisis. This trouble leads to astonishment, which may be understood as a deeper awakening and realization. Wisdom then becomes associated with transformed understanding and spiritual authority, represented by the saying's language of **reigning**.

The Coptic form concludes with the seeker reigning over **"the All,"** while the surviving Greek form adds **rest** after reigning. Within Christian theological interpretation, this rest may be understood as peace in Truth, Wisdom, and ultimately God. However, the paper carefully distinguishes between what the text explicitly states and what is proposed as theological interpretation.

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1. Introduction

The second saying of the *Gospel of Thomas* is a short saying, but it contains a profound sequence of spiritual transformation.

The central movement can be represented as:

Seeking → Finding → Trouble → Astonishment → Reigning

in the Coptic witness, while the surviving Greek witness gives:

Seeking → Finding → Astonishment → Reigning → Rest.

The saying therefore does not simply tell a person to search for something.

It describes what happens **after the person begins seeking**.

The seeker searches.

The seeker finds.

Finding produces a reaction.

In the Coptic form, the reaction first appears as trouble or disturbance.

The disturbance leads to astonishment.

Astonishment leads to reigning.

And the Coptic saying ends with:

“He will reign over the All.”

The Greek witness adds:

“Having reigned, he will rest.”

This creates a powerful theological picture:

The seeker begins in search and ultimately arrives at transformation and rest.

---

2. Purpose of the Study

The purpose of this research paper is to examine Saying 2 through four levels:

1. Textual study

To consider the Coptic and Greek forms.

2. Word study

To examine the important words associated with seeking, finding, trouble, astonishment, reigning, and resting.

3. Spiritual interpretation

To understand the progression as a journey of the seeker.

4. Christian theological interpretation

To relate the journey to **Knowledge, Wisdom, Truth, the Spirit of Truth, Jesus Christ, spiritual authority, and rest**.

The distinction between these levels is important.

The lexical meaning of a word should not automatically be confused with a later theological interpretation.

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3. The Coptic Witness

The Coptic text used in the research materials is:

ⲡⲉⲧⲉ ϩⲓ ⲡⲉⲧⲉ ⲯⲓⲛⲉ ⲙ̄ⲡⲉϥⲕⲱ ⲉⲯⲓⲛⲉ ⲯⲁⲛⲧⲉϥϩⲉ· ⲁⲩⲱ ⲉϥϩⲉ ⲛ̄ϥⲧⲱⲙ ⲉⲣⲟϥ· ⲁⲩⲱ ⲉϥⲧⲱⲙ ⲉⲣⲟϥ ⲛ̄ϥ̄ⲯⲡⲏⲣⲉ· ⲁⲩⲱ ⲛ̄ϥ̄ⲯⲡⲏⲣⲉ ⲛ̄ϥ̄ⲣ̄ⲣ̄ⲣⲟ ⲉⲭⲛ̄ⲧⲏⲣⲟⲩ

The research paper on Saying 2 translates the Coptic progression as:

“Let him who seeks continue seeking until he finds. When he finds, he will become troubled. When he becomes troubled, he will be astonished, and he will reign over the All.”

The important sequence is therefore:

Seeking → Finding → Trouble → Astonishment → Reigning over the All

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4. The Greek Witness

The surviving Greek form is reconstructed approximately as:

λέγει Ἰησοῦς· μὴ παυσάσθω ὁ ζητῶν τοῦ ζητεῖν ἕως ἂν εὕρῃ, καὶ ὅταν εὕρῃ θαμβηθήσεται, καὶ θαμβηθεὶς βασιλεύσει, καὶ βασιλεύσας ἀναπαήσεται.

Transliteration:

legei lēsous; mē pausasthō ho zētōn tou zētein heōs an heurē, kai hotan heurē thamvēthēsetai, kai thamvētheis basileusei, kai basileusas anapaēsetai.

The Greek progression is:

Seeking → Finding → Astonishment → Reigning → Rest.

This difference between the two witnesses is important.

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5. The First Principle: The Seeker Must Not Give Up

The first spiritual principle of Saying 2 is **perseverance**.

The seeker must continue.

The seeker must not stop.

The Greek construction contains:

μὴ παυσάσθω

meaning approximately:

“Let him not stop.”

It is followed by:

ὁ ζητῶν

“the one who seeks.”

And:

τοῦ ζητεῖν

“to seek.”

The repetition of the concept of seeking gives the opening a strong emphasis.

The idea can therefore be expressed:

The one who seeks must continue seeking.

Or:

Do not give up the search.

The seeker may encounter difficulty.

The seeker may experience confusion.

The seeker may experience trouble.

But he must continue.

---

6. Special Principle: Continue Until You Find

The next important expression is:

ἕως ἂν εὕρῃ

“until he finds.”

The Greek verb is:

εὑρίσκω — heuriskō

meaning:

to find, discover, obtain.

This gives the search a destination.

The saying does not simply say:

“Keep searching forever.”

It says:

“until he finds.”

Therefore:

Seeking has a goal.

The seeker is moving toward discovery.

---

7. Seeking Knowledge

Within this researcher's Christian theological interpretation, the seeker may be understood as searching for **Knowledge**.

Knowledge is the beginning of conscious understanding.

A person begins with questions.

He observes.

He studies.

He investigates.

He listens.

He examines.

He searches.

Thus:

Seeking → Knowledge

Knowledge allows the seeker to understand what has been discovered.

But knowledge alone is not the final stage.

---

8. Seeking Wisdom

Knowledge and Wisdom should not be treated as identical.

The Greek word:

γνῶσις — gnōsis

belongs to the semantic field of:

knowledge / knowing.

The Greek word:

σοφία — sophia

belongs to the semantic field of:

wisdom / understanding / discernment.

Your related research paper emphasizes that these are distinct lexical fields.

Therefore, the theological progression proposed here is:

Knowledge → Wisdom

Knowledge provides understanding.

Wisdom provides discernment concerning that understanding.

---

9. Wisdom and Truth

The third major Greek word in your related research is:

ἀλήθεια — alētheia

meaning:

Truth / reality.

The research emphasizes that **γνῶσις does not literally mean σοφία, σοφία does not literally mean ἀλήθεια, and ἀλήθεια does not literally mean γνῶσις**. Their relationship is therefore conceptual and theological rather than simply lexical.

The proposed theological progression is:

Knowledge → Wisdom → Truth

Thus, the seeker begins by seeking understanding and moves toward deeper discernment and recognition of Truth.

---

10. Finding Truth

Saying 2 says:

“until he finds.”

The text itself does not specify:

“until he finds Truth.”

That identification is a theological interpretation.

The Greek verb **εὑρίσκω** simply means **find/discover**.

Nevertheless, within this Christian theological model, the object of the search may be understood as Truth.

Thus:

The seeker seeks Knowledge.

Knowledge develops into Wisdom.

Wisdom directs the seeker toward Truth.

The seeker finds.

This gives the finding a deeper theological significance.

---

11. Finding May Produce Trouble

The Coptic witness introduces an important stage:

Finding → Trouble

The seeker finds, but finding does not immediately produce comfort.

Instead, the seeker becomes troubled.

The research materials identify this as one of the significant differences between the Coptic and Greek forms.

This creates a profound spiritual principle:

Truth may disturb before Truth brings peace.

Why?

Because Truth may challenge what the seeker previously believed.

The seeker may have developed an understanding based upon incomplete knowledge.

When a deeper Truth is discovered, the former understanding may be shaken.

Therefore:

Finding Truth can become a crisis of understanding.

---

12. Trouble as Transformation

Trouble should not necessarily be interpreted as the final destination.

The Coptic saying immediately moves forward:

Trouble → Astonishment

Therefore, trouble becomes part of a larger transformation.

The seeker may experience:

- uncertainty,
- inner conflict,
- questioning,
- disturbance,
- reconsideration,
- rejection of false assumptions,
- deeper investigation.

The trouble can therefore be understood as a transition.

The seeker is moving from an **old understanding** toward a **new understanding**.

---

13. Special Note on Evil Spirits

A Christian interpretation may include the possibility of spiritual opposition.

The seeker may encounter:

deception, temptation, confusion, fear, or spiritual opposition.

The user's proposed interpretation includes the possibility that **evil spirits may trouble the seeker during the search for Truth**.

This can be incorporated into a broader Christian theology of spiritual conflict.

However, an important scholarly distinction must remain:

Thomas Saying 2 itself does not explicitly say that evil spirits cause the trouble.

The text says that the seeker **becomes troubled**.

Therefore:

Textual statement:

The seeker becomes troubled.

Theological possibility:

The trouble may include spiritual opposition.

The second statement goes beyond the explicit wording of the saying.

---

14. Trouble Leads to Astonishment

The next stage is:

“When he becomes troubled, he will be astonished.”

This is one of the most beautiful movements in the Coptic form.

The sequence is:

Finding

↓

Trouble

↓

Astonishment

The Greek verb:

θαμβέω — thambeō

has the semantic field of astonishment, amazement, or being overwhelmed.

The seeker therefore moves from disturbance to wonder.

---

15. Astonishment as Spiritual Awakening

Within the theological interpretation, astonishment may represent a moment of awakening.

The seeker realizes:

“What I have found is greater than what I previously understood.”

His former intellectual framework may no longer be sufficient.

He begins to perceive more deeply.

Therefore:

Trouble can become the doorway to astonishment.

And astonishment can become the doorway to deeper understanding.

---

16. Astonishment and Wisdom

The theological progression can now be expressed:

Knowledge

↓

Wisdom

↓

Truth

↓

Trouble

↓

Astonishment

The seeker has moved beyond merely possessing information.

He is being transformed by what he has discovered.

Wisdom therefore becomes important because wisdom allows the seeker to understand the significance of the Truth he has encountered.

---

17. Reigning

The next major movement is:

Astonishment → Reigning

The Greek word is:

βασιλεύω — basileuō

meaning:

to reign, to be king, to exercise royal authority.

The Coptic uses an expression involving:

ⲣ̄ⲣⲟ

associated with:

king / reigning.

Therefore the royal language is genuinely part of the saying.

---

18. What Does “Reign” Mean?

The literal lexical meaning concerns:

royal authority / reigning / being king.

The text does not explicitly define this reign as:

political power,

or:

government over human beings.

Therefore, a theological interpretation should be distinguished from the literal lexical meaning.

Within the Christian framework of this paper, **reigning** can be interpreted as **spiritual authority**.

The progression becomes:

Truth

↓

Transformation

↓

Wisdom

↓

Spiritual Authority

↓

Reign

Your related research proposes this connection between Truth, Christ, transformation, spiritual authority, and reign.

---

19. Reigning Through the Wisdom of Truth

The seeker does not reign merely because he has acquired information.

The theological interpretation is deeper:

Knowledge gives understanding.

Wisdom gives discernment.

Truth transforms the seeker.

Transformation produces spiritual authority.

Therefore:

Reigning is understood as the consequence of transformation by Truth and Wisdom.

This is a theological interpretation of the saying.

---

20. “Reign Over the All”

The Coptic saying ends with:

ϵϫⲛ̄ⲧⲏⲣⲟⲩ

and the expression:

ⲡⲧⲏⲣϥ

is understood as:

the All / everything / all things.

The final Coptic movement is therefore:

Astonishment → Reigning → Over the All

The expression gives the saying a broad cosmic dimension.

However, the precise theological meaning of **“the All”** should not be expanded beyond the evidence without additional argument.

---

21. The Greek Ending: Rest

The Greek witness gives another important word:

ἀναπαήσεται — anapaēsetai

from:

ἀναπαύω — anapauō

meaning:

rest / receive rest.

The phrase:

καὶ βασιλεύσας ἀναπαήσεται

can be translated:

“and having reigned, he will rest.”

This produces:

Reign → Rest

The Coptic Nag Hammadi form does not preserve this final stage.

Therefore, the **rest** belongs specifically to the surviving Greek witness and should not be presented as though it were present in the surviving Coptic ending.

---

22. Rest in the Wisdom of Truth

Within this theological interpretation, the Greek concept of rest can be understood as the culmination of the journey.

The seeker has:

sought

then:

found

then:

been troubled

then:

become astonished

then:

received wisdom

then:

reigned

and finally:

rested.

Therefore:

Rest can be understood as the peace that follows transformation.

The seeker is no longer governed by the same uncertainty with which he began.

---

23. Rest in Peace of Mind

The phrase **“peace of mind”** is a theological application rather than a literal translation of the Greek verb.

Nevertheless, it provides a useful way of describing the final theological condition.

The seeker has moved:

from uncertainty to understanding

from confusion to wisdom

from disturbance to astonishment

from searching to finding

from seeking to discovery

from discovery to transformation

from transformation to spiritual authority

from reigning to rest.

Therefore:

Rest may be understood as peace of mind in the Wisdom of Truth.

---

24. The Spirit of Truth

Your broader Christian theological framework connects the discovery of Truth with the **Spirit of Truth**.

The proposed model is:

Spirit of Truth

↓

Divine Illumination

↓

Human Spirit

↓

Knowledge

↓

Wisdom

↓

Truth

The connection between the Spirit of Truth and the seeker is a Christian theological synthesis based especially on the Johannine concept of the Spirit of Truth; it is not a lexical definition of the words in Thomas 2.

---

25. Truth and Jesus Christ

Within Christian theology, Truth can further be understood christologically:

Truth → Jesus Christ, the Living Word

This connection is developed in your related theological research.

Again, this is important:

ἀλήθεια does not lexically mean "Jesus Christ."

Rather, Christian theology identifies Truth with Christ in a theological and biblical framework.

Your research explicitly distinguishes this theological synthesis from the lexical meaning of **ἀλήθεια**.

---

26. Truth Must Be Lived

The ultimate goal is not merely:

Truth Known

The fuller theological progression is:

Truth Known

↓

Truth Understood

↓

Truth Received

↓

Truth Lived

Your related research describes this movement as a process of transformation.

Therefore, the seeker does not simply discover Truth intellectually.

Truth becomes a principle by which the seeker lives.

---

27. Saying 1 and Saying 2

Saying 1 and Saying 2 can be read together.

Saying 1

“Whoever finds the interpretation of these sayings will not taste death.”

Saying 2

“The one who seeks should not stop seeking until he finds.”

The relationship can therefore be represented:

Interpretation

↓

Seeking

↓

Finding

↓

Transformation

The research materials already identify this relationship between the interpretation of the sayings and the seeking/finding motif.

This provides a useful literary connection between the first two sayings.

---

28. Seven-Stage Spiritual Journey

The entire theological interpretation can now be organized into seven stages.

Stage 1 — SEEK

Do not give up.

The seeker continues searching.

Stage 2 — FIND

Continue until you find.

The search reaches discovery.

Stage 3 — TROUBLE

Finding challenges the old understanding.

The seeker becomes disturbed.

Stage 4 — ASTONISHMENT

The disturbance opens into wonder.

The seeker realizes something greater than his previous understanding.

Stage 5 — WISDOM

Knowledge becomes discernment.

The seeker begins to understand the significance of what has been found.

Stage 6 — REIGN

Truth and Wisdom transform the seeker.

The saying describes the result as reigning over the All.

Stage 7 — REST

The Greek witness adds rest.

Theologically, this can be understood as peace in Truth and Wisdom.

---

29. Complete Spiritual Formula

The entire journey can be represented as:

SEEK

↓

FIND

↓

TROUBLE

↓

ASTONISHMENT

↓

WISDOM

↓

REIGN

↓

REST

Or, more specifically:

Seek Knowledge

↓

Find Truth

↓

Be Troubled by the Challenge of Truth

↓

Become Astonished

↓

Receive Wisdom

↓

Reign through Truth

↓

Rest in Wisdom and Peace

---

30. Textual Meaning and Theological Meaning

It is important to maintain two levels of interpretation.

What the text explicitly says

The saying describes:

seeking,

finding,

trouble in the Coptic witness,

astonishment,

reigning,

reigning over the All in the Coptic witness,

and rest in the surviving Greek witness.

What the Christian theological interpretation proposes

The theological model connects these stages with:

Knowledge,

Wisdom,

Truth,

spiritual transformation,

the Spirit of Truth,

Jesus Christ,

spiritual authority,

peace,

and rest.

The second level should not be confused with the first.

This distinction makes the theological interpretation stronger because it clearly identifies where interpretation begins.

---

31. The Seeker and Transformation

The deepest question of Saying 2 is not simply:

“What does the seeker find?”

It is:

“What happens to the seeker after he finds?”

The answer given by the structure of the saying is remarkable.

He does not simply become comfortable.

He becomes:

troubled

then:

astonished

then:

reigning.

The Greek witness adds:

rest.

Therefore the finding changes the seeker.

---

32. Finding Truth Changes the Seeker

Within the theological interpretation:

Finding Truth → Transformation

Truth challenges the old understanding.

The old understanding is disturbed.

The disturbance produces astonishment.

Astonishment opens the mind and heart to deeper wisdom.

Wisdom produces spiritual maturity.

Spiritual maturity is represented by the language of reigning.

And the Greek witness completes the movement with rest.

Thus:

Truth is not merely discovered. Truth transforms the person who discovers it.

---

33. Knowledge → Wisdom → Truth → Reign → Rest

The complete theological model developed through the two research studies may therefore be summarized as:

Knowledge

↓

Wisdom

↓

Truth

↓

Transformation

↓

Spiritual Authority

↓

Reign

↓

Rest

This model should be understood as a theological framework rather than as a claim that Thomas 2 itself explicitly contains every one of these concepts.

---

34. Final Conclusion

Gospel of Thomas, Saying 2 presents a powerful image of the seeker.

The seeker must not give up.

He must continue seeking.

He must continue until he finds.

Finding, however, is not necessarily comfortable.

The Coptic witness says that the seeker becomes troubled.

The trouble leads to astonishment.

Astonishment leads to reigning over the All.

The Greek witness gives a related form in which astonishment leads to reigning and reigning leads to rest.

Within a Christian theological interpretation, this journey can be understood as:

Seeking Knowledge

↓

Finding Truth

↓

Being Troubled by the Challenge of Truth

↓

Becoming Astonished

↓

Growing in Wisdom

↓

Receiving Spiritual Authority

↓

Reigning through Truth

↓

Resting in Wisdom and Peace

The central principle is therefore:

✝️ SEEK UNTIL YOU FIND. ✝️

Do not give up.

Do not stop because the search is difficult.

Do not fear the disturbance that may come when your former understanding is challenged.

Allow the discovery of Truth to transform you.

Allow Knowledge to become Wisdom.

Allow Wisdom to lead you toward Truth.

Allow Truth to reign within your life.

And, in the Greek witness of Saying 2:

“Having reigned, he will rest.”

Thus the complete theological journey can be summarized:

✝️ Seek → Find → Trouble → Astonishment → Wisdom → Reign → Rest ✝️

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35. Final Research Statement

The central thesis of this paper is:

The seeker does not reach the goal merely by searching; he reaches transformation through finding. Finding may disturb the old understanding, disturbance may lead to astonishment, astonishment may open the way to wisdom and spiritual authority, and the Greek witness finally describes rest. Within Christian theology, this journey may be understood as a movement from Knowledge to Wisdom, from Wisdom toward Truth, from Truth toward transformation, and from transformation toward spiritual authority and peace.

This interpretation preserves an essential distinction:

The Coptic and Greek texts provide the textual foundation; the identification of the finding with Truth, the interpretation of trouble as spiritual conflict, the connection with the Spirit of Truth and Christ, and the interpretation of rest as peace in the Wisdom of Truth constitute the Christian theological synthesis.

✝️ Short Summary for the Blog

A person who seeks should not give up. He should continue seeking until he finds. Within a Christian theological reading, he seeks Knowledge, Wisdom, and Truth. When he finds, the discovery may trouble him because Truth challenges his former understanding. When he becomes troubled, he becomes astonished. Through Wisdom and Truth, he is transformed and receives spiritual authority, symbolized by the saying's language of reigning over the All. The surviving Greek witness then adds that, having reigned, he will rest. Therefore the spiritual journey may be summarized as:

SEEK → FIND → TROUBLE → ASTONISHMENT → WISDOM → REIGN → REST. ✝️

[Blog Version]

✝️[Pawan Upadhyay Bible] Seek and Find [Gospel of Thomas, Saying 2]✝️

Introduction

The second saying of the *Gospel of Thomas* presents a remarkable spiritual journey: **seeking, finding, trouble, astonishment, reigning, and—according to the surviving Greek form—rest**.

The Coptic text preserved in the Nag Hammadi manuscript gives the following progression:

Seeking → Finding → Trouble → Astonishment → Reigning over the All

The Greek witness gives a closely related progression:

Seeking → Finding → Astonishment → Reigning → Rest

My purpose in this study is to read this saying as a spiritual journey of a person who refuses to give up searching for **knowledge, wisdom, and Truth**.

✝️ The Coptic Text of Saying 2

ⲡⲉⲧⲉ ϩⲓ ⲡⲉⲧⲉ ⲯⲓⲛⲉ ⲙ̄ⲡⲉϥⲕⲱ ⲉⲯⲓⲛⲉ ⲯⲁⲛⲧⲉϥϩⲉ· ⲁⲩⲱ ⲉϥϩⲉ ⲛ̄ϥⲧⲱⲙ ⲉⲣⲟϥ· ⲁⲩⲱ ⲉϥⲧⲱⲙ ⲉⲣⲟϥ ⲛ̄ϥⲣ̄ⲯⲡⲏⲣⲉ· ⲁⲩⲱ ⲛ̄ϥⲣ̄ⲯⲡⲏⲣⲉ ⲛ̄ϥⲣ̄ⲣ̄ⲣⲟ ⲉⲭⲛ̄ⲧⲏⲣⲟⲩ

The Coptic witness is represented in your research paper as the sequence:

“Let him who seeks continue seeking until he finds. When he finds, he will become troubled. When he becomes troubled, he will be astonished, and he will reign over the All.”

---

1. The Person Who Seeks — He Should Not Give Up

The saying begins with **the seeker**.

The seeker is a person who has recognized that he does not yet possess the fullness of what he is looking for.

He therefore begins to **seek**.

The important principle is:

The seeker must not give up.

Seeking is not a one-time activity. It is a continuing journey.

The saying therefore presents a person who keeps asking, searching, examining, learning, praying, and pursuing understanding.

Seek.

Continue seeking.

Do not stop.

The goal is not simply to accumulate information.

The seeker is looking for something that can transform his understanding of life.

2. He Continues Seeking Until He Finds Knowledge, Wisdom, and Truth

The Coptic expression for seeking is associated with:

ⲱⲓⲛⲉ — shine

The movement is:

Seeking → Finding

The seeker is not told to search without purpose.

He is told to continue **until he finds**.

This creates an important spiritual principle:

The search has a destination.

Within my Christian theological interpretation, the object of this search can be understood as **Knowledge, Wisdom, and ultimately Truth**.

The distinction is important:

Knowledge

Knowledge gives understanding of what has been revealed.

Wisdom

Wisdom gives discernment concerning what that knowledge means and how it should be lived.

Truth

Truth is not merely information. Truth becomes something that transforms the person who encounters it.

Thus I understand the journey as:

Seeking → Knowledge → Wisdom → Truth

My earlier word study emphasizes that this is a **theological model**, not a claim that the individual Greek words literally mean one another.

---

3. Finding May Bring Trouble

The Coptic form contains an important stage that is absent from the surviving Greek form in the same position:

Finding → Trouble

After the seeker finds, he becomes troubled.

This is a remarkable statement.

Why should finding produce trouble?

One theological interpretation is that **Truth challenges the old understanding of the seeker**.

The person may have believed something for many years.

Then he discovers something deeper.

His former understanding is shaken.

His assumptions are questioned.

His mind is disturbed.

His heart is challenged.

Therefore:

Finding Truth may produce an inner crisis.

The trouble should not necessarily be understood as failure.

It may be part of transformation.

---

4. Trouble and the Spiritual Conflict of Seeking Truth

The saying itself says that the seeker becomes troubled, but **it does not explicitly identify the cause of the trouble as evil spirits**.

Therefore, the statement that evil spirits may trouble the seeker should be understood as a **Christian theological interpretation**, rather than as the literal wording of Thomas 2.

Within a Christian spiritual framework, however, one may understand the journey as involving spiritual opposition.

When a person seeks Truth, he may encounter:

- deception,
- fear,
- confusion,
- temptation,
- false understanding,
- spiritual opposition,
- resistance to change.

Thus the seeker may experience a struggle between:

Truth and deception

Wisdom and foolishness

Light and darkness

Understanding and confusion

But the seeker must continue.

He should not give up.

---

5. When He Finds, He Becomes Troubled

The Coptic sequence is particularly powerful:

ⲉϥϩⲉ → ⲛϥⲧⲱⲙ ⲉⲣⲟϥ

The conceptual movement is:

He finds → He becomes troubled

Finding therefore does not immediately mean that everything becomes comfortable.

Sometimes Truth first **disturbs** before it **comforts**.

Truth exposes false assumptions.

Truth reveals what was hidden.

Truth forces the seeker to reconsider himself.

Truth demands transformation.

Therefore:

Finding Truth is not necessarily the end of the struggle. It may be the beginning of a deeper transformation.

---

6. When He Becomes Troubled, He Becomes Astonished

The next movement is:

Trouble → Astonishment

The Coptic expression ⲣ̄ⲱⲡⲏⲣⲉ carries the idea of **marveling, wondering, or being astonished**.

This is important because the troubled seeker does not remain permanently in confusion.

His disturbance leads toward a new perception.

He begins to see something he had not previously understood.

Therefore:

Trouble → deeper understanding → astonishment

Astonishment can represent the moment when the seeker realizes:

“What I have discovered is greater than what I previously understood.”

The discovery becomes an experience of **wonder**.

---

7. Astonishment Leads to Reigning

The final movement of the Coptic saying is:

Astonishment → Reigning

The Coptic expression for reigning is associated with:

ⲣⲣⲣⲟ

The corresponding Greek verb is:

βασιλεύω — basileuō

meaning:

to reign, to be king, to exercise royal authority.

This is a very powerful conclusion.

The seeker does not merely become someone who **knows more**.

The saying uses the language of **reigning**.

---

8. “He Will Reign Over the All”

The Coptic ending is:

ⲛϥⲣⲣⲟ ⲉⲭⲛⲧⲏⲣⲟⲩ

Conventionally:

“He will reign over the All.”

The expression ⲡⲧⲏⲣϥ has the sense of:

the All / everything / all things.

This gives the conclusion a very broad scope.

The progression has therefore become:

Seeking

↓

Finding

↓

Trouble

↓

Astonishment

↓

Reigning over the All

Your research paper appropriately notes that interpreting “the All” more specifically—such as identifying it with a particular spiritual or cosmic structure—is an interpretive question beyond the simple lexical meaning.

---

9. Reigning Through the Wisdom of Truth

My theological interpretation is that this **reigning** should not automatically be understood as political domination.

The text uses royal language, but it does not explicitly say that the seeker becomes a political ruler.

Within a Christian theological reading, reigning can instead be understood as **spiritual authority through Truth**.

The progression becomes:

Knowledge

↓

Wisdom

↓

Truth

↓

Transformation

↓

Spiritual authority

↓

Reigning

This connects with my broader theological model in which Truth is understood in relation to Jesus Christ, the Living Word, and the Spirit of Truth.

Thus:

The person does not reign because he has merely collected knowledge.

Rather:

He reigns because Truth has transformed him.

---

10. The Greek Witness Adds “Rest”

The surviving Greek form gives an additional final stage:

καὶ βασιλεύσας ἀναπαήσεται

“and having reigned, he will rest.”

The verb:

ἀναπαύω — anapauō

has the sense:

rest, receive rest, cease from activity.

Therefore the Greek progression becomes:

Seek → Find → Astonishment → Reign → Rest

The Coptic Nag Hammadi form, however, ends with:

“he will reign over the All.”

It does **not** preserve the Greek “rest” at the end.

Therefore, when I speak of **rest after reigning**, I am bringing together the Greek witness with the theological interpretation of the saying.

---

11. Rest in the Wisdom of Truth

The final idea of **rest** has profound spiritual significance.

After the long journey of seeking:

Seek

After discovery:

Find

After the disturbance:

Trouble

After awakening:

Astonishment

After authority:

Reign

comes:

Rest

Within my theological interpretation, this rest can be understood as:

rest in the Wisdom of Truth.

The seeker no longer lives in the constant uncertainty of ignorance.

His mind has been illuminated.

His understanding has been transformed.

His heart has been awakened.

He has discovered Truth and learned to live according to Truth.

Therefore:

Truth produces wisdom, and wisdom produces peace.

---

12. Rest in Peace of Mind

The final theological application is **peace of mind**.

The journey begins with a person who is searching.

Searching can involve uncertainty.

Finding can produce trouble.

Trouble can produce astonishment.

Astonishment can lead to transformation.

Transformation can lead to spiritual authority.

And the Greek witness concludes with **rest**.

Therefore the complete spiritual movement can be expressed:

Seeking → Finding → Trouble → Astonishment → Wisdom → Reign → Rest

The seeker begins with questions.

He ends with peace.

---

13. The Complete Christian Interpretation

Putting the seven stages together:

1. Seek

Do not give up.

The seeker continues searching.

2. Find

He seeks knowledge, wisdom, and Truth.

3. Trouble

The discovery of Truth challenges his former understanding.

4. Astonishment

The troubled seeker comes to a deeper realization.

5. Wisdom

He begins to understand the Truth that he has encountered.

6. Reign

Through Truth and wisdom, he receives spiritual authority and is described as reigning over the All.

7. Rest

In the Greek witness, after reigning he rests.

Theologically, this can be understood as:

rest in the Wisdom of Truth and peace of mind.

✝️ The Great Spiritual Sequence

I therefore understand Gospel of Thomas Saying 2 through this sequence:

SEEK
↓
Do not give up
↓
FIND
↓
Knowledge of Truth
↓
Wisdom of Truth
↓
TROUBLE
↓
Former understanding
is shaken
↓
ASTONISHMENT
↓
Deeper realization
↓
REIGN
↓
Truth and Wisdom
govern within
↓
REST
↓

The core message can therefore be expressed as:

“Do not stop seeking until you find. Finding may trouble you; trouble may awaken you to astonishment; astonishment may lead to wisdom and spiritual authority; and the journey ultimately leads toward rest.”

✝️ Conclusion: Seek Until You Find

Gospel of Thomas Saying 2 presents the seeker with a demanding command:

Do not stop seeking.

The seeker must continue until he finds.

But the discovery is not necessarily comfortable.

The Coptic witness says that **finding leads to trouble**.

Trouble leads to **astonishment**.

Astonishment leads to **reigning over the All**.

The Greek witness adds another word:

Rest.

For a Christian theological reading, this journey can be understood as a movement from **knowledge to wisdom, from wisdom toward Truth, from Truth toward transformation, from transformation toward spiritual authority, and finally toward rest**.

The important distinction must always be maintained: **these theological connections are an interpretation of the saying, not the lexical definition of every word in the Coptic text.** Your research itself makes this distinction between textual evidence and theological synthesis.

Therefore, my central message from Saying 2 is:

Seek Truth.

Do not give up.

Find Truth.

Allow Truth to transform you.

Receive the Wisdom of Truth.

Let Truth reign in your life.

And enter into the rest and peace that follows.

✝️ **Seek → Find → Trouble → Astonishment → Wisdom → Reign → Rest** ✝️

✝️ [Pawan Upadhyay Bible] Special Notes

Seek and Find — Gospel of Thomas, Saying 2 ✝️

📌 Special Note 1 — The Central Message

Gospel of Thomas, Saying 2 presents a spiritual journey:

Seek → Find → Trouble → Astonishment → Reign → Rest

The Coptic witness ends with **reigning over the All**, while the surviving Greek witness continues to **rest**.

The saying therefore presents not merely a command to search, but a **process of transformation**.

📌 Special Note 2 — The Seeker Must Not Give Up

The first principle is:

“The person who seeks should not give up.”

The seeker is called to continue searching.

He should not stop because the search is difficult.

He should not stop because he becomes confused.

He should not stop because the answer does not immediately appear.

Spiritual principle

Continue seeking until you find.

The emphasis is therefore on **perseverance**.

📌 Special Note 3 — Seeking

The Coptic word associated with seeking is:

ϣⲓⲛⲉ — šine

Meaning:

to seek, search, look for, inquire.

The Greek equivalent is related to:

ζητέω — zēteō

with the sense:

seek, search for, look for, inquire.

Spiritual meaning

The seeker searches for:

Knowledge → Wisdom → Truth

This is a theological interpretation rather than the lexical definition of the Coptic verb.

📌 Special Note 4 — “Until He Finds”

The next movement is:

Seeking → Finding

The Coptic verb associated with finding is:

ϭⲓⲛⲉ — čine

and the Greek verb is:

εὑρίσκω — heuriskō

meaning:

to find, discover, obtain.

The important phrase is:

“until he finds.”

Therefore, the seeker is not presented as someone who must search forever without an objective.

There is a **finding**.

📌 Special Note 5 — Finding Knowledge, Wisdom, and Truth

Within this Christian theological interpretation, the finding can be understood as the discovery of:

Knowledge

Understanding what has been revealed.

Wisdom

Understanding and discerning the significance of that knowledge.

Truth

Recognizing and living according to what is true.

Therefore:

Seeking → Knowledge → Wisdom → Truth

This should be understood as a **theological model**, not as a claim that the Coptic or Greek words themselves literally mean “knowledge,” “wisdom,” and “truth.” Your research on γνῶσις, σοφία, and ἀλήθεια makes this distinction explicitly.

📌 Special Note 6 — Finding Can Produce Trouble

The Coptic witness contains an important stage:

Finding → Trouble

The seeker finds, but immediately encounters disturbance.

The Coptic terminology expresses the idea of being:

troubled / disturbed / shaken.

Your research identifies this as one of the significant differences between the Coptic and surviving Greek forms.

Spiritual interpretation

The discovery of Truth can challenge the seeker's previous understanding.

Therefore:

Truth may first disturb before it brings peace.

Old assumptions may be shaken.

Former understanding may need to be abandoned.

The seeker may have to learn to see reality differently.

📌 Special Note 7 — Spiritual Opposition

A Christian reader may understand the trouble as including spiritual conflict.

The seeker may experience:

- confusion,
- fear,
- temptation,
- deception,
- resistance,
- spiritual opposition.

However, an important textual distinction must be maintained:

Thomas 2 itself does not explicitly say that evil spirits cause the trouble.

Therefore, the connection with evil spirits belongs to **Christian theological interpretation**, not to the literal wording of the saying.

📌 Special Note 8 — Trouble Is Not the End

The Coptic progression continues:

Trouble → Astonishment

The troubled seeker does not remain permanently in disturbance.

The Coptic expression associated with astonishment is:

ⲱⲡⲏⲣⲉ — špēre

in the expression for:

marveling / being astonished.

Thus the disturbance becomes a doorway toward a deeper realization.

Spiritual progression

Finding

↓

Trouble

↓

Astonishment

The seeker begins to see something that he had not previously understood.

📌 Special Note 9 — Astonishment

The Greek witness uses:

θαμβηθήσεται — tham-bē-thē-se-tai

from:

θαμβέω — thambeō

with the sense of:

being astonished, amazed, overwhelmed.

Astonishment is therefore a significant stage of the journey.

The seeker discovers something so profound that his previous understanding cannot simply remain unchanged.

📌 Special Note 10 — Astonishment Leads to Reigning

The next movement is:

Astonishment → Reign

The Greek verb is:

βασιλεύω — basileuō

meaning:

to reign, be king, exercise royal authority.

The Coptic has a corresponding expression involving:

ⲣ̄ⲣⲟ **— rro**

“king.”

Thus the saying moves from **inner transformation** toward **royal language**.

📌 Special Note 11 — Reigning Is Not Necessarily Political

The text says:

“He will reign.”

But it does not explicitly say:

“He will become a political ruler.”

Nor does it explicitly describe political government.

Therefore, within a Christian theological reading, “reign” may be interpreted as **spiritual authority**, while the lexical meaning remains:

reign / be king / exercise royal authority.

Your research makes this distinction between the text and theological interpretation.

📌 Special Note 12 — Reigning Through Wisdom of Truth

Within the theological framework developed in your research:

Knowledge → Wisdom → Truth → Transformation → Spiritual Authority → Reign

The seeker does not reign simply because he has accumulated information.

Rather, the proposed theological interpretation is:

Truth transforms the seeker.

Then:

Wisdom guides the transformed seeker.

And:

Spiritual authority follows transformation.

Your research describes this as **Truth → Christ → Transformation → Spiritual Authority → Reign**.

📌 Special Note 13 — “He Will Reign Over the All”

The Coptic ending contains:

ⲉⲭⲛ̄ⲧⲏⲣⲟⲩ

with:

ⲡⲧⲏⲣϥ — the All / everything / all things

The Coptic saying therefore concludes:

“He will reign over the All.”

This gives the conclusion a cosmic or universal scope.

Exactly what “the All” refers to is an interpretive question and should not be narrowed beyond what the wording itself establishes.

📌 Special Note 14 — The Greek Adds Rest

The Greek witness continues:

καὶ βασιλεύσας ἀναπαήσεται

“and having reigned, he will rest.”

The important verb is:

ἀναπαύω — anapauō

meaning:

to rest / receive rest.

Therefore the Greek progression is:

Seek → Find → Astonishment → Reign → Rest

The Coptic Nag Hammadi form does not preserve this final “rest”; it ends with reigning over the All.

📌 Special Note 15 — Rest in the Wisdom of Truth

Within the theological interpretation:

Rest

can be understood as the culmination of the journey.

The seeker has moved from uncertainty toward understanding.

He has moved from knowledge toward wisdom.

He has moved toward recognition of Truth.

Therefore:

Rest in the Wisdom of Truth

can be understood spiritually as a condition in which the mind no longer remains governed by confusion and uncertainty.

📌 Special Note 16 — Rest in Peace of Mind

The Greek ending provides the beautiful movement:

Reign → Rest

A theological application can therefore describe the final condition as:

Peace of mind

Peace in Truth

Peace in Wisdom

Rest in God

The phrase **“peace of mind”** is an interpretive application, not a lexical translation of **ἀναπαήσεται**.

📌 Special Note 17 — Knowledge, Wisdom, and Truth

The complete theological model may be expressed:

Seeking

↓

Knowledge

↓

Wisdom

↓

Truth

↓

Trouble

↓

Astonishment

↓

Transformation

↓

Spiritual Authority

↓

Reign

↓

Rest

Your separate word-study research summarizes the conceptual relationship as:

γνῶσις → σοφία → ἀλήθεια

while emphasizing that these are distinct Greek words with distinct semantic fields.

📌 Special Note 18 — The Spirit of Truth

Within your Christian theological framework, the discovery of Truth can be connected with the **Spirit of Truth**.

Your research proposes:

Spirit of Truth

↓

Divine Illumination

↓

Human Spirit

↓

Knowledge

↓

Wisdom

↓

Truth

↓

Jesus Christ, the Living Word

↓

Truth Reigns Within

This is a Christian theological synthesis rather than something explicitly stated in every word of Thomas 2.

📌 Special Note 19 — Truth Must Transform the Seeker

The deepest point is not merely:

“I found Truth.”

The greater question is:

“What happens to me after I find Truth?”

Thomas 2 answers with a sequence of transformation:

Finding

↓

Trouble

↓

Astonishment

↓

Reigning

And the Greek witness:

Reigning

↓

Rest

Thus Truth is not merely something to **possess**.

It is something by which the seeker is **transformed**.

📌 Special Note 20 — Saying 1 and Saying 2

There is an important connection with Saying 1.

Saying 1

Find the interpretation of these sayings.

Saying 2

Seek until you find.

Therefore:

Saying 1 — Interpretation

↓

Saying 2 — Seeking and Finding

↓

Transformation

↓

Reigning

↓

Rest

Your earlier research identifies this relationship between the interpretation of the sayings and the seeking/finding process.

📌 Special Note 21 — The Seven-Stage Spiritual Journey

For this theological reading, Saying 2 can be summarized in seven stages:

① SEEK

Do not give up.

② FIND

Continue until you discover what you are seeking.

③ TROUBLE

Truth challenges the old understanding.

④ ASTONISHMENT

The seeker begins to perceive more deeply.

⑤ WISDOM

Knowledge is understood and becomes wisdom.

⑥ REIGN

Truth and wisdom produce spiritual authority.

⑦ REST

The Greek witness concludes with rest.

✝️ Special Note 22 — The Complete Formula

SEEK → FIND → TROUBLE → ASTONISHMENT → WISDOM → REIGN → REST

Or, in theological language:

Seek Knowledge.

Find Truth.

Allow Truth to challenge you.

Be astonished by what you discover.

Receive Wisdom.

Let Truth reign within you.

Enter into rest and peace.

✝️ Final Special Note

Gospel of Thomas Saying 2 can therefore be read as a profound **journey of the seeker**.

The person who seeks must not give up.

He continues seeking until he finds.

Finding may trouble him because Truth challenges his former understanding.

Trouble leads to astonishment.

Astonishment opens the way toward wisdom and transformation.

The transformed seeker is described as one who **reigns over the All**.

And in the surviving Greek witness, after reigning:

“he will rest.”

Therefore, in the Christian theological interpretation developed here:

Seek until you find.

Find until you understand.

Understand until you receive Wisdom.

Receive Wisdom until Truth transforms you.

Let Truth reign within you.

And rest in the Wisdom and peace of Truth. ✝️

Core sequence:

ⲯⲓⲛⲉ → ⲥⲓⲛⲉ → ⲯⲧⲣⲧⲣ̄ → ⲯⲡⲏⲣⲉ → ⲣ̄ⲣⲟ → ἀναπαύω

Seek → Find → Trouble → Astonishment → Reign → Rest

✝️[Pawan Upadhyay Bible]✝️

✝️[Gospel of Thomas — Saying 2]✝️

“**Jesus said:**

Let him who seeks continue seeking until he finds. When he finds, he will become troubled. When he becomes troubled, he will be astonished, and he will reign over the All.”

Here is the complete sequence, including the ending preserved in the Greek tradition:

✝️[Gospel of Thomas — Saying 2]✝️

Jesus said:

“Let the one who seeks continue seeking until he finds.

When he finds, he will be troubled.

When he has been troubled, he will marvel.

And he will reign over the All.

And having reigned, he will rest.”

The spiritual progression

Seek → Find → Be Troubled → Marvel → Reign → Rest

https://archive.org/details/pawanupadhyaybibleresearchpapers